City Attorney's Impartial Analysis of Measure T

The City Council of Fowler placed Measure T on the ballot for the November 3, 2026, election ("Measure"). The City of Fowler ("City") currently imposes a 1% transactions and use tax pursuant to Section 3-5.12 of Chapter 5 of Title 3 of the Fowler Municipal Code. The Measure, if approved by voters, adds a new Chapter 11 to Title 3 of the Fowler Municipal Code which establishes a new transactions and use tax at the rate of 0.5% such that the total combined transactions and use tax rate is 1.5%.

The tax established by the Measure would be assessed on the sale of tangible goods and the storage, use, or other consumption of such goods. This tax would be paid in addition to current sales taxes and would be collected at the same time and in the same manner as existing sales taxes. Both visitors and City residents would pay this tax on retail sales activity in Fowler. Certain purchases, such as groceries or prescription medicine, would be exempt from this tax. However, the specific purchases subject to this tax would be determined under State law and regulations. The California Department of Tax and Fee Administration would administer the tax under contract with the City. If approved, the Measure will generate approximately $300,000 annually. This tax is a general tax and revenue generated by the tax would be placed in the City's general fund, are not restricted, and may be used for any City general fund purpose.

A "YES" vote is a vote to approve the Measure. A "NO" vote is a vote against the Measure. The Measure would take effect only if it receives a majority "YES" vote at the November 3, 2026 election.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of the Measure. If you desire a copy of the Measure, please call the City of Fowler's City Clerk's Office at 559-834-3113 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

Roy C. Santos
City Attorney
City of Fowler

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